

WEEKLY ETF REVIEW

Friday, 22 May 2026

Investor Report

This report is for informational and educational purposes only; please see the disclaimer at the end.

PRIMARY REGIME

Risk-on growth (66% confidence)

GEOPOLITICAL REGIME

Mixed / not yet decisive

MAIN TAKEAWAY

SMH remains the earned leader, but fresh capital and replacement decisions must pass regime, pricing and duel-evidence checks.



PORTFOLIO ACTION SNAPSHOT

Recommendation	Tickers / notes
Add	SMH
Hold	SPY , SMH , PPA , PAVE , URNM , GLD
Hold but replaceable	SPY , PPA , PAVE , GLD remain under explicit review.
Reduce	None
Close	None

BEST REPLACEMENTS TO FUND

- No challenger is promoted to a fundable replacement yet. Each named replacement must first clear the same close-date pricing basis and relative-strength duel.



REGIME DASHBOARD

Regime snapshot

- **Current regime:** Risk-on growth
- **Confidence:** 66%
- **Decision rule:** Macro supports selection discipline, not broad risk expansion by default.

What changed

- AI / semiconductor leadership remains the dominant equity impulse.

- Gold hedge behavior remains under review rather than automatic ballast.

Portfolio implications

- Risk appetite is supportive, but fresh adds still need position-size room and pricing confirmation.
- Growth and infrastructure lanes can be considered if they do not worsen concentration.
- Defensive hedges should be reviewed for opportunity cost.

Cross-asset confirmation

- Semiconductor leadership supports [SMH](#), but [SPY](#) overlap must remain explicit.
- Small-cap and duration signals are not strong enough to justify broad beta expansion.
- Gold is treated as a hedge review item unless price behavior improves.

Policy catalysts transferred to the report

- **AI infrastructure and semiconductor supply chains:** Capital spending and strategic supply-chain policy continue to support semiconductor and infrastructure lanes. Affected lanes: AI compute infrastructure, Grid buildout / electrification.
- **Defense and sovereign resilience:** Defense-budget durability remains a structural support, but ETF vehicle choice still matters. Affected lanes: Defense innovation / sovereign resilience.

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STRUCTURAL OPPORTUNITY RADAR

Theme	Primary ETF	Alternative ETF	Why it matters	Structural fit	Macro timing	Status	What needs to happen	Time horizon
AI compute infrastructure	SMH	SOXX	Semiconductor and AI capex remains the cleanest funded structural growth lane. Macro filter: Regime and price leadership still support AI compute exposure, but concentration discipline applies.	5	5	Actionable now	AI infrastructure leadership remains persistent, but position-size discipline matters.	3-12 months
Cybersecurity resilience	CIBR	BUG	Cyber spend is linked to AI, cloud, data-center and geopolitical resilience.	4	4	Actionable now	Offers digital-infrastructure exposure with less direct semiconductor cyclicality.	3-12 months

Theme	Primary ETF	Alternative ETF	Why it matters	Structural fit	Macro timing	Status	What needs to happen	Time horizon
Grid buildout / electrification	PAVE	GRID	Power demand, grid bottlenecks and reshoring capex support infrastructure spend. Macro filter: AI power demand and infrastructure policy support the grid lane; funding still depends on PAVE -vs- GRID duel evidence.	5	4	Actionable now	PAVE remains useful, but GRID is the cleaner thematic challenger.	3-12 months
Broad commodity inflation hedge	GSG	DBC	Broad commodities may hedge inflation better than single-metal or single-gold exposure.	3	3	Watchlist / under review	Useful only if commodity breadth confirms.	3-12 months
Industrial automation and factory software	ROBO	IRBO	Automation capex can broaden beyond semiconductors into industrial productivity.	4	3	Watchlist / under review	Needs clearer industrial order momentum.	3-12 months
Robotics / automation	BOTZ	ROBO	Automation is a structural productivity lane but overlaps partly with AI hardware.	4	3	Watchlist / under review	Needs industrial capex breadth and ETF momentum.	3-12 months

Best structural opportunities not yet actionable

- Food security / agriculture inputs
- Water infrastructure / treatment
- Critical minerals / copper / refining

Notable lanes assessed but not promoted this week

Theme	Primary ETF	Why not promoted	What would change that
Copper and electrification materials	COPX	Structural case is credible, but 3-month price momentum is still negative.	Becomes more fundable if copper momentum and China demand confirm.
Defense innovation / sovereign resilience	PPA	Scored below the live radar cutoff versus stronger funded and challenger lanes.	The lane remains relevant, but PPA must justify itself versus ITA .
Agricultural commodities	DBA	Scored below the live radar cutoff versus stronger funded and challenger lanes.	Useful only if commodity stress becomes visible.
Non-U.S. developed market diversification	IEFA	Structural case is credible, but 3-month price momentum is still negative. Direct replacement duel versus SPY : 1m -2.35%; 3m -9.81%.	Becomes fundable if U.S. factor concentration rises or non-U.S. breadth improves.
Nuclear utilities and clean baseload	NLR	Scored below the live radar cutoff versus stronger funded and challenger lanes.	Can diversify URNM if fuel-cycle volatility is too high.

4A. Short Opportunity Radar

Short theme	Candidate ETF	Short thesis	Trigger	Invalidation	Time horizon	Confidence
Rate-sensitive small caps	IWM	Restrictive real rates pressure weaker balance sheets.	IWM breaks down versus SPY while yields firm.	Clear easing impulse and better credit breadth.	1-3 months	Medium
China platform beta	KWEB	Policy confidence remains fragile.	Failed rally or renewed FX/policy stress.	Durable stimulus and earnings recovery.	1-3 months	Medium
Long-duration bonds	TLT	Sticky inflation and real-rate risk remain headwinds.	Real yields rise again.	Growth scare and decisive lower-yield breakout.	1-3 months	Medium
Speculative clean-tech beta	ICLN	Financing pressure and weak profitability remain issues.	Failure to recover in broad risk-on tape.	Sharp rate relief or major policy surprise.	3-12 months	Medium

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KEY RISKS / INVALIDATORS

- [SPY](#) plus [SMH](#) creates high U.S. tech / AI factor overlap.
- [GLD](#) remains a hedge review, not an unquestioned ballast position.
- [PPA](#) and [PAVE](#) remain replaceable until their ETF implementation quality is proven.
- Non-U.S. equity exposure remains a diversification gap.

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BOTTOM LINE

- **Portfolio stance:** Risk appetite is supportive, but fresh adds still need position-size room and pricing confirmation.
- **Best earned exposure:** [SMH](#) remains the portfolio's strongest contributor and cleanest secular growth expression.
- **Main discipline issue:** Growth and infrastructure lanes can be considered if they do not worsen concentration.

- **Weakest implementation questions:** [PPA](#) must prove itself against [ITA](#), [PAVE](#) must prove itself against [GRID](#), and [GLD](#) must prove that it still behaves like useful ballast.
- **Action bias:** Defensive hedges should be reviewed for opportunity cost.



EQUITY CURVE AND PORTFOLIO DEVELOPMENT

- Starting capital (EUR): 100000.00
- Current portfolio value (EUR): 107376.69
- Since inception return (%): 7.38
- Equity-curve state: Reconciled to Section 15 with full valuation history
- EUR/USD used: 1.1603
- Notes: Section 7 uses `output/etf_valuation_history.csv` plus the current runtime NAV; Section 15 is rendered from the same normalized runtime state.

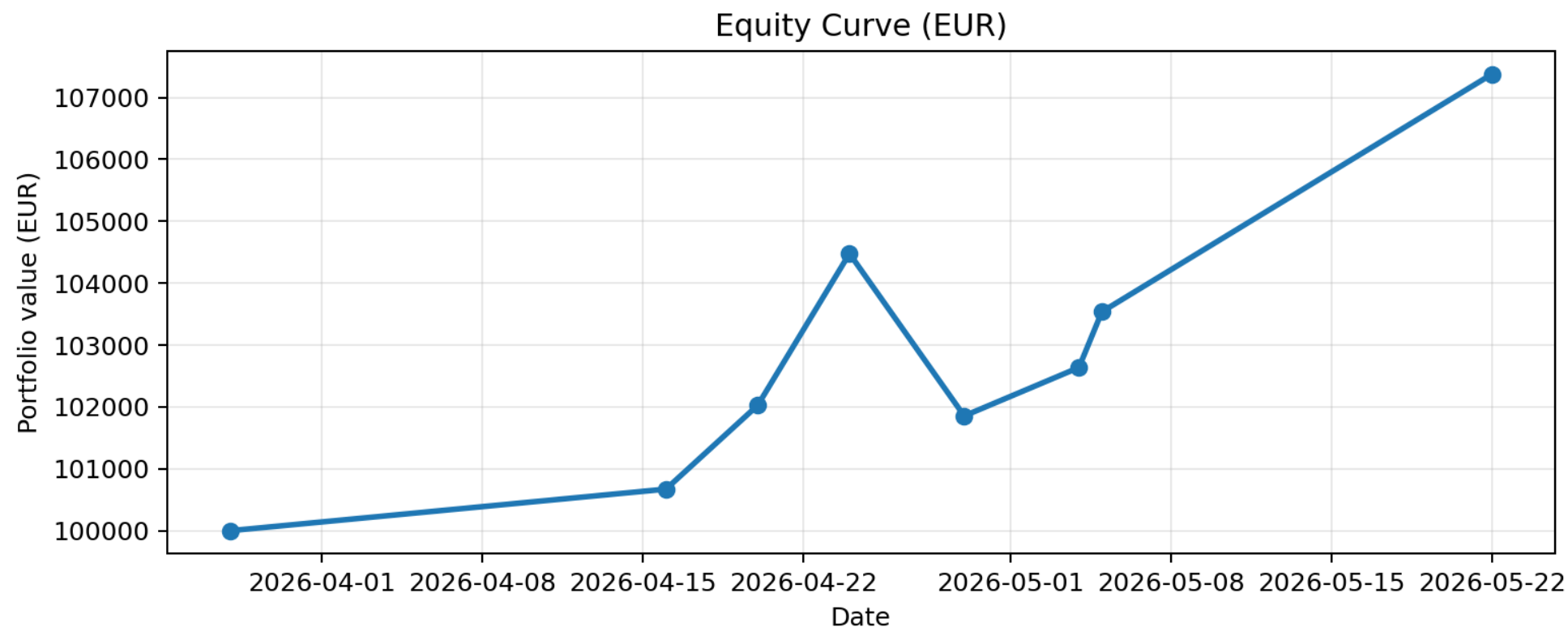
Date	Portfolio value (EUR)	Comment
2026-03-28	100000.00	Inaugural model portfolio established
2026-04-16	100671.75	Fresh per-ticker repricing using latest completed close set
2026-04-20	102026.08	Fresh six-of-six repricing using completed 20 April close set
2026-04-24	104477.54	Fresh five-of-six repricing; PPA carried forward
2026-04-29	101854.68	Fresh six-of-six repricing using persisted 2026-04-29 audit
2026-05-04	102636.85	Fresh five-of-six pricing recovery; GLD carried forward
2026-05-05	103536.96	Latest 4 May close basis; +8 SMH executed from cash
2026-05-22	107376.69	Runtime-derived valuation from pricing audit and explicit portfolio state

Closing prices used in this report

The portfolio valuation above is based on the per-position closes shown here. Requested close date: **2026-05-22**. The source column shows the market-data layer that supplied the close, not internal resolver names.

Holding	Requested close	Close date used	Close used	Currency	Market-data source	Status
SPY	2026-05-22	2026-05-22	745.64	USD	Twelve Data	Fresh close
SMH	2026-05-22	2026-05-22	576.32	USD	Twelve Data	Fresh close
PPA	2026-05-22	2026-05-22	170.24	USD	Twelve Data	Fresh close
PAVE	2026-05-22	2026-05-22	54.94	USD	Twelve Data	Fresh close
URNM	2026-05-22	2026-05-22	58.22	USD	Yahoo Finance history	Fresh close
GLD	2026-05-22	2026-05-22	413.82	USD	Twelve Data	Fresh close

FX basis	Requested date	Date used	Rate	Source	Status
EUR/USD	2026-05-22	2026-05-22	1.1603	Twelve Data	Fresh close



7A. ETF Position Performance

Performance is calculated on the current ETF holdings using the latest validated close-price audit and available market-history inputs.

Portfolio sleeve	Investment thesis	Tradable ETF	Weight %	1w return	1m return	3m return	Since-entry	P/L EUR	Contribution %
Core beta	Core U.S. large-cap exposure	SPY	24.54%	+0.88%	+5.25%	+9.57%	+6.17%	2,449.10	+2.45%
Growth engine	AI compute / semiconductor leadership	SMH	27.29%	+3.59%	+19.61%	+39.59%	+20.61%	7,942.03	+7.94%
Resilience	Defense and sovereign resilience	PPA	15.03%	+3.43%	+0.93%	-4.84%	-6.97%	-734.71	-0.73%
Real-asset capex	Grid and infrastructure capex	PAVE	13.71%	-0.85%	-2.50%	+0.15%	+8.25%	793.38	+0.79%
Strategic energy	Nuclear and uranium cycle exposure	URNM	7.99%	-3.21%	-15.78%	-19.21%	-0.55%	-1,367.63	-1.37%

Portfolio sleeve	Investment thesis	Tradable ETF	Weight %	1w return	1m return	3m return	Since-entry	P/L EUR	Contribution %
Hedge ballast	Hard-asset geopolitical and inflation hedge	GLD	9.63%	-0.83%	-3.99%	-14.02%	-11.14%	-1,560.08	-1.56%

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Analyst Report

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ASSET ALLOCATION MAP

Bucket	Stance	Reason
US equities	Neutral	Investable but concentration risk is explicit.
Europe equities	Neutral	Watchlist only; non-U.S. exposure remains a diversification gap.
EM equities	Underweight	USD and oil sensitivity remain headwinds.
large cap	Neutral	Quality leadership still works.
small cap	Underweight	Rates and refinancing remain difficult.
growth	Neutral	Selective growth led by SMH remains attractive.
quality	Overweight	Earnings durability remains valuable.
gold	Neutral	Hedge role under review.
industrials / defense	Overweight	Structural thesis valid; vehicle under review.
non-USD assets	Watchlist	Zero allocation is an explicit U.S. exceptionalism bet.

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SECOND-ORDER EFFECTS MAP

Driver	First-order effect	Second-order effect	Likely beneficiaries	Likely losers	ETF implication	Timing	Confidence
AI leadership	SMH remains the cleanest growth expression	Concentration must be watched	SMH , SOXX	Lower-quality cyclicals	Hold near max size	Immediate	High
Factor concentration	SPY and SMH overlap	Portfolio is less diversified than ticker count suggests	QUAL , IEFA watchlist	Overlapping U.S. beta	Keep SPY under review	1-3 months	Medium
Defense thesis vs ETF implementation	Defense remains structurally valid	PPA must justify itself versus ITA	ITA , PPA	Weak vehicle selection	Hold PPA under review	Immediate	Medium
Hedge drawdown	GLD hedge role must be proven	GSG/BIL remain challengers	GSG , BIL , cash	Unproductive hedge	Hold GLD under review	Immediate	Medium

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CURRENT POSITION REVIEW

Ticker	Action	Score	Fresh cash	Role	Required next action
SPY	Hold	3.53	Smaller / under review	Core beta	Force alternative duel; upgrade, reduce, replace, or close
SMH	Add	4.28	Smaller / under review	Growth engine	Force alternative duel; upgrade, reduce, replace, or close
PPA	Hold under review	3.45	Reduce	Resilience	Force alternative duel; upgrade, reduce, replace, or close
PAVE	Hold under review	3.68	Smaller / under review	Real-asset capex	Force alternative duel; upgrade, reduce, replace, or close
URNM	Hold	3.70	Hold	Strategic energy	Hold
GLD	Hold under review	3.00	Reduce	Hedge ballast	Run hedge validity test and compare with alternatives

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BEST NEW OPPORTUNITIES

- [SMH](#) remains the leading funded growth exposure, subject to the max-position rule.
- [CIBR](#) / [BUG](#): Cyber spend is linked to AI, cloud, data-center and geopolitical resilience.
- [GSG](#) / [DBC](#): Broad commodities may hedge inflation better than single-metal or single-gold exposure.
- [ROBO](#) / [IRBO](#): Automation capex can broaden beyond semiconductors into industrial productivity.
- Replacement candidates remain evidence-gated: pricing basis and duel status must be visible before funding.

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REPLACEMENT DUEL TABLE

Current holding	Challenger	1m edge	3m edge	Pricing basis	Decision	Required trigger
SPY	IWM	-1.77%	+0.08%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-05-22 / 2026-05-22.	Challenger improving; keep duel active.	Needs repeat 3m edge and capital source.
SPY	QUAL	-1.13%	-3.35%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-05-22 / 2026-05-22.	Current holding still leads; no replacement.	Needs sustained relative outperformance.
SPY	IEFA	-2.35%	-9.81%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-05-22 / 2026-05-22.	Current holding still leads; no replacement.	Needs sustained relative outperformance.
SPY	EFA	-2.54%	-10.04%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-05-22 / 2026-05-22.	Current holding still leads; no replacement.	Needs sustained relative outperformance.
PPA	ITA	+1.93%	-1.69%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-05-22 / 2026-05-22.	Early 1m improvement only; wait for 3m confirmation.	Needs 3m confirmation.
PAVE	GRID	+6.63%	+10.48%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-05-22 / 2026-05-22.	Replacement trigger watch — challenger leading over 3m.	Confirm thesis fit, liquidity and funding source.

Current holding	Challenger	1m edge	3m edge	Pricing basis	Decision	Required trigger
GLD	GSG	+5.61%	+43.80%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-05-22 / 2026-05-22.	Replacement trigger watch — challenger leading over 3m.	Confirm thesis fit, liquidity and funding source.
GLD	BIL	+4.29%	+14.91%	Current and challenger closes validated on 2026-05-22 / 2026-05-22.	Replacement trigger watch — challenger leading over 3m.	Confirm thesis fit, liquidity and funding source.



PORTFOLIO ROTATION PLAN

Close	Reduce	Hold	Add	Replace
None	None	SPY , SMH , PPA , PAVE , URNM , GLD	SMH	SPY , PPA , PAVE , GLD



FINAL ACTION TABLE

Ticker	ETF	Existing/ New	Weight Inherited	Target Weight	Suggested Action	Conviction Tier	Total Score	Portfolio Role	Better Alternative Exists?	Short Reason
SPY	SPDR S&P 500 ETF Trust	Existing	24.32	24.32	Hold	Tier 2	3.53	Core beta	Yes	Useful but overlaps with SMH ; no fresh cash add
SMH	VanEck Semiconductor ETF	Existing	21.35	24.69	Add	Tier 1	4.28	Growth engine	No	Best earned use of cash, capped below 25%
PPA	Invesco Aerospace & Defense ETF	Existing	15.04	15.04	Hold under review	Tier 3	3.45	Resilience	Yes	Valid thesis but must prove itself versus ITA
PAVE	Global X U.S. Infrastructure Development ETF	Existing	14.45	14.45	Hold under review	Tier 2	3.68	Real-asset capex	Yes	Valid but GRID is the named challenger

Ticker	ETF	Existing/ New	Weight Inherited	Target Weight	Suggested Action	Conviction Tier	Total Score	Portfolio Role	Better Alternative Exists?	Short Reason
URNM	Sprott Uranium Miners ETF	Existing	9.48	9.48	Hold	Tier 2	3.70	Strategic energy	No	Valid, but not better than SMH for new cash today
GLD	SPDR Gold Shares	Existing	10.14	10.14	Hold under review	Tier 3	3.00	Hedge ballast	Yes	Hedge validity must be proven after double-digit drawdown

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POSITION CHANGES EXECUTED THIS RUN

Ticker	Previous weight %	New weight %	Weight change %	Shares delta	Action executed	Funding source / note
SPY	24.54	24.54	0.00	0.00	None	Hold; overlap review versus SMH
SMH	27.29	27.29	0.00	8.00	Buy	Funded from cash; stays below 25% max position size
PPA	15.03	15.03	0.00	0.00	None	Hold under review; compare versus ITA next run
PAVE	13.71	13.71	0.00	0.00	None	Hold under review; compare versus GRID next run
URNM	7.99	7.99	0.00	0.00	None	Hold; not better than SMH for cash this run
GLD	9.63	9.63	0.00	0.00	None	Hold under hedge-validity review
CASH	-	1.80	-	0.00	None	Residual cash

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CURRENT PORTFOLIO HOLDINGS AND CASH

- Starting capital (EUR): 100000.00
- Invested market value (EUR): 105440.17

- Cash (EUR): 1936.52
- Total portfolio value (EUR): 107376.69
- Since inception return (%): 7.38
- EUR/USD used: 1.1603

Ticker	Shares	Price (local)	Currency	Market value (local)	Market value (EUR)	Weight %
SPY	41.00	745.64	USD	30571.24	26347.48	24.54
SMH	59.00	576.32	USD	34002.88	29305.00	27.29
PPA	110.00	170.24	USD	18726.40	16139.14	15.03
PAVE	311.00	54.94	USD	17086.34	14725.67	13.71
URNM	171.00	58.22	USD	9955.62	8580.14	7.99
GLD	29.00	413.82	USD	12000.78	10342.74	9.63
CASH	-	1.00	EUR	1936.52	1936.52	1.80



CONTINUITY INPUT FOR NEXT RUN

Portfolio table

Ticker	ETF Name	Direction	Weight %	Avg Entry	Current Price	P/L %	Original Thesis	Role
SPY	SPDR S&P 500 ETF Trust	Long	24.54	676.33	745.64	6.17	Core U.S. large-cap exposure	Core beta
SMH	VanEck Semiconductor ETF	Long	27.29	420.13	576.32	20.61	AI compute / semiconductor leadership	Growth engine
PPA	Invesco Aerospace & Defense ETF	Long	15.03	177.99	170.24	-6.97	Defense and sovereign resilience	Resilience
PAVE	Global X U.S. Infrastructure Development ETF	Long	13.71	51.98	54.94	8.25	Grid and infrastructure capex	Real-asset capex
URNM	Sprott Uranium Miners ETF	Long	7.99	67.50	58.22	-0.55	Nuclear and uranium cycle exposure	Strategic energy
GLD	SPDR Gold Shares	Long	9.63	476.24	413.82	-11.14	Hard-asset geopolitical and inflation hedge	Hedge ballast

Available cash

- Cash %: 1.80
- Margin usage %: 0.00
- Leverage allowed: No

Watchlist / dynamic radar memory

Theme	Primary ETF	Alternative ETF	Why I'm considering it	Current status
AI compute infrastructure	SMH	SOXX	Strongest secular growth exposure.	Active
Defense innovation / sovereign resilience	PPA	ITA	Defense thesis valid but vehicle under review.	Duel required
Grid buildout / electrification	PAVE	GRID	Infrastructure capex remains valid.	Duel required
Gold hedge review	GLD	GSG / BIL	Hedge role must be proven.	Under review
Non-U.S. developed diversification	IEFA	EFA	Portfolio has zero non-U.S. exposure.	Watchlist

Recommendation discipline continuity

- [SPY](#): overlap review versus [SMH](#) remains active.
- [PPA](#): direct duel versus [ITA](#) required.
- [PAVE](#): direct duel versus [GRID](#) required.
- [GLD](#): hedge validity test required.
- Replacement challengers: not fundable without completed duel.

Constraints

- Max position size: 25%
- Max number of positions: 8
- UCITS only: No
- Leverage ETFs allowed: No
- Drawdown tolerance: Moderate
- Income vs growth preference: Balanced growth with resilience bias

Changes since last review

- Added: a validated state-led production path with macro-policy regime input; no portfolio position was added unless shown in Section 14.
- Reduced: None unless explicit state says otherwise.
- Closed: None.
- Thesis changes: No structural thesis was abandoned; implementation and macro-regime discipline are materially tighter.

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DISCLAIMER

This report is provided for informational and educational purposes only. It is not investment, legal, tax, or financial advice, and it is not a recommendation to buy, sell, or hold any security. It does not take into account the specific investment objectives, financial situation, or particular needs of any recipient. Views are general in nature, may change without notice, and may not be suitable for every investor. Investing involves risk, including possible loss of principal.